

Advantage Automation

Run Guide - Start to End

How to add course components (workunits) into Advantage from your Excel file, using **add_components.py**. Which files to open, what to change, how to run it, and how to read the logs.
Your laptop setup (Python, VS Code, Playwright) is already done. This guide starts from there.

Item	Value
Project folder	C:\Automation\advantage-sis-bot
Script	add_components.py
Excel it reads	data\automation_ready.xlsx (tab: Components)
Login details	.env
Results	logs\ (CSV logs + screenshots)
Site	https://advantage.fameinc.com/login (LIVE)
School / tenant	Royal Treatment Beauty Academy (tenant: royal)
Program	Cosmetology

This is the LIVE site. Every save changes real school data. Always follow the order in Part 6: dry run, then 1 row, then a few rows, then all.

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How the script works, in simple words

1. Reads your login from **.env**.
2. Reads the **Components** tab of the Excel. Only rows with **Run = Yes**.
3. Opens Edge, logs in, picks the school (tenant), opens **Cosmetology** → **Definition**.
4. Clicks **ADD/VIEW COURSE** and opens the course, for example *Written Exams (Quizzes + Exams) - Cosmetology*.
5. For each row: if the component is already in the course, it **skips** it.
6. Otherwise: **New Component** → fills Description, System component type, Status, Campus → Save.
7. In the course grid: picks the component, fills Number, Weight, Min Score, Sequence, ticks the checkboxes → Save → Confirm.
8. Writes one line per row in a **log file**. On an error it takes a **screenshot** and stops.

Part 1 - Your files

```
C:\Automation\advantage-sis-bot\
|-- .env                                <- your login (private)      EDIT once
|-- add_components.py                  <- the automation script    EDIT settings at top
|-- data\
|   |-- automation_ready.xlsx <- the rows to add                CHECK / EDIT
|-- logs\                             <- results + screenshots    READ after each run
|-- recorded.txt                      <- your original recording  don't need to touch
|-- step1_open.py                    <- setup test              don't need to touch
|-- step2_read_excel.py              <- setup test              don't need to touch
|-- main.py                          <- old runner               don't need to touch
|-- .venv\                           <- Python box               never edit
```

File	What it is	Do you edit it?
.env	Site address, username, password, tenant	Once (Part 2)
add_components.py	The script that does the work	Only the SETTINGS block at the top (Part 5)
data\automation_ready.xlsx	One row = one component to add	Only the yellow columns (Part 4)
logs\components_*.csv	Result of each run	No - just read it (Part 8)
logs*.png	Screenshots of errors / dry runs	No - just open it

recorded.txt still has your real password in it. Open it, replace the password with PASSWORD, save. Then change that password.

Part 2 - One time: set up the .env file

Open it from the terminal (Part 3 shows how to open the terminal):

```
code .env
```

It must look exactly like this. Each line starts with the **name**, then **=**, then the value. No spaces, no quotes.

```
SIS_URL=https://advantage.fameinc.com/login
SIS_USER=your_username
SIS_PASS=your_password
SIS_TENANT=royal
SIS_TENANT_OPTION=RoyalTreatmentBeautyAcademy
```

Line	What it means
SIS_URL	The Advantage login page
SIS_USER / SIS_PASS	Your Advantage login
SIS_TENANT	What you type in the Tenant box after login
SIS_TENANT_OPTION	The school name you click in the Tenant list

Press **Ctrl + S** to save.

Check it worked: Get - Content .env shows the 5 lines (it will show your password - only on your screen).

Never email or share .env. For another school later, change SIS_TENANT and SIS_TENANT_OPTION.

Part 3 - Every time: open the project in the terminal

1. Open **VS Code**.
2. Click **Terminal** → **New Terminal**.
3. Type these two lines (press Enter after each):

```
cd C:\Automation\advantage-sis-bot
.venv\Scripts\activate
```

Check it worked: the line starts with **(.venv)**. Now you can run the script.

Part 4 - The Excel file

Open it: double-click **dataautomation_ready.xlsx** in File Explorer, or type:

```
start data\automation_ready.xlsx
```

The tabs

Tab	What it has
How to use	Short notes on the file
Components	The rows the script adds. One row = one component.
Subjects	The subjects from the guide and how many components each has
Needs Review	Rows that were skipped or need a decision from you

Columns in the Components tab

Column	Goes into Advantage as	Edit?
A Row ID	Number used in logs and for resuming	No
B Run	Yes = add this row, No = skip it	Yes
C Subject	From the guide	No
D Course	The course clicked after ADD/VIEW COURSE	No
E Seq	Sequence in the grid	No
F Component Name	Description (New Component) + grid component	Careful
G Name Length / H Over 25	Calculated check (red = over 25 characters)	No
I Type in Guide	From the guide	No
J System Component Type	System component type dropdown	Yes
K Status / L Campus	Status and Campus dropdowns	Yes
M Number / N Weight / O Min Score	Grid: number, weight, minimum score	Yes
P Required / Q Must Pass	Grid checkboxes (Yes / No)	Yes
S Notes	Why a row is set to Run = No	No

Rules

- **Don't rename or move columns.** The script finds them by their header name.
- Dropdown values (J, K, L) must be spelled **exactly** like in Advantage.
- Yes / No only - not Y, yes, TRUE.

- Save and close Excel before running the script.

What is in the file now

Rows	Count	Run
Written Exam components	337	Yes
Practical Exam components	7	No - Advantage type unknown, Required/Must Pass empty
Placeholder row, Clinic subjects	-	Not included (see Needs Review)

To run only some rows, set **Run = No** on the others, or use LIMIT and START_FROM_ROW_ID (Part 5). To use a new configuration guide or another program, send the new file to Claude and it will make a new automation_ready.xlsx.

Part 5 - Settings at the top of add_components.py

Open the script:

```
code add_components.py
```

Only change the **SETTINGS** block near the top (about lines 24 - 37). Don't change anything below it.

```
# ===== SETTINGS (edit these) =====
EXCEL_FILE = "data/automation_ready.xlsx"
SHEET = "Components"

LIMIT = 1                # how many rows to process this run (start with 1)
DRY_RUN = True           # True = fill the New Component form for 1 row, do NOT click Save
START_FROM_ROW_ID = 1    # skip rows with a smaller "Row ID" (use this to resume)
ALLOW_LIVE = False       # must be True to SAVE on the live site advantage.fameinc.com

BROWSER_CHANNEL = "msedge"
SLOW_MO = 250

PROGRAM_SEARCH_TEXT = "Cosmetology"
PROGRAM_OPTION = "#programAndProgramVersions-option-3"
```

Setting	What it does	When to change
LIMIT	How many rows this run	1 → 3 → 10 → 50 → 400
DRY_RUN	True = fill the form, never save	False when you are ready to save
START_FROM_ROW_ID	Start at this Row ID	To continue after a stop (Part 9)
ALLOW_LIVE	Safety lock for the live site	True only when you are allowed to save on live
BROWSER_CHANNEL	msedge = Microsoft Edge	Rarely
SLOW_MO	Pause between clicks (ms)	Bigger (500) if the site is slow
PROGRAM_SEARCH_TEXT / PROGRAM_OPTION	Which program version to open	Only for another program / version

After changing, press **Ctrl + S**.

If DRY_RUN = False on the live site but ALLOW_LIVE = False, the script stops with: *"Stopped: SIS_URL is the LIVE site..."*. This is the safety lock working.

Part 6 - Run plan, step by step

Do these rounds **in order**. Don't jump to all rows. After each round, check the log (Part 8) and Advantage (Part 10).

Round	LIMIT	DRY_RUN	ALLOW_LIVE	What happens
0 Test	1	True	False	Fills the New Component form for 1 row. Saves nothing.
1 First save	1	False	True	Adds 1 component. Check it carefully in Advantage.
2	3	False	True	Adds the next rows (already added ones are skipped).
3	10	False	True	Check the log for any ERROR.
4	50	False	True	Check a few in Advantage.
5 All	400	False	True	Adds everything left with Run = Yes.

Round 0 - Test (saves nothing)

1. Settings: LIMIT = 1, DRY_RUN = True, ALLOW_LIVE = False. Save.
2. Close the Excel file.
3. Run:

```
python add_components.py
```

1. Edge opens, logs in, opens Cosmetology and the course, and fills the New Component form.
2. Look at the form: Description, System component type (Exam), Status (Active), Campus.
3. Click in the terminal and press **Enter**. The browser closes. Nothing was saved.

Round 1 - First real save

1. Settings: LIMIT = 1, DRY_RUN = False, ALLOW_LIVE = True. Save.
2. Run `python add_components.py`.
3. When it finishes, check the log (Part 8) and the component in Advantage (Part 10).
4. **Check which checkbox got ticked** (Required / Must Pass). If it's wrong, stop and tell Claude.

Rounds 2 - 5

1. Change only **LIMIT** (3, then 10, then 50, then 400). Save.
2. Run `python add_components.py`.
3. Check the log after each run.

Running again is safe: components already in the course are **skipped**, not added twice. The row you created while recording (*Ch 01 Career Paths for Cosmetologists Quiz*) will show as SKIPPED.

When you are finished

Lock it again so nothing is saved by mistake next time:

```
DRY_RUN = True  
ALLOW_LIVE = False  
LIMIT = 1
```

Part 7 - What you see while it runs

The terminal prints one line per step. Example:

```
10:15:02 3 row(s) to process | DRY_RUN=False | site=LIVE
10:15:02 Opening https://advantage.fameinc.com/login
10:15:14 Logged in
10:15:25 Opened program: Cosmetology
10:15:31 Opened course: Written Exams (Quizzes + Exams) - Cosmetology
10:15:52 OK #1 Ch 01 Ancient Cultures Quiz (saved in grid row [0])
10:15:53 SKIP #2 Ch 01 Career Paths for Cosmetologists Quiz (already there)
10:16:15 OK #3 Ch 01 Chapter Exam (saved in grid row [1])
10:16:15 Done. OK=2 skipped=1 errors=0. Log: logs/components_20260925_101502.csv
```

Word	Meaning
OK	Component created and added to the course
SKIP	Already in the course - nothing done
DRY	Test run - form filled, not saved
ERROR	Something failed - screenshot saved, script stopped

Don't click in the browser while it runs. To stop it, click in the terminal and press **Ctrl + C**.

Part 8 - Logs and screenshots

Where they are

File	What it is
logs\components_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS.csv	One log per run (date and time in the name)
logs\error_row<ID>.png	Screenshot when a row failed
logs\dryrun_row<ID>_component.png	Screenshot of the filled form in a dry run

Open them from the terminal

```
dir logs
$last = Get-ChildItem logs\components_*.csv |
    Sort-Object LastWriteTime | Select-Object -Last 1
Get-Content $last
start $last
start logs\error_row5.png
```

Line 1 lists the files. Lines 2 - 4 show the newest log in the terminal. The next line opens it in Excel. The last line opens a screenshot (change the number).

Log columns

Column	Meaning
time	When the row was done
row_id	The Row ID from the Excel (column A)
course	Course it was added to
component	Component name
status	OK / SKIPPED / DRY-RUN / ERROR
message	Details, for example the grid row or the error reason

```
time,row_id,course,component,status,message
10:15:52,1,Written Exams...,Ch 01 Ancient Cultures Quiz,OK,saved in grid row [0]
10:15:53,2,Written Exams...,Ch 01 Career Paths for Cos...,SKIPPED,already in course
10:16:40,4,Written Exams...,Ch 01 Early Twentieth...,ERROR,Timeout 20000ms exceeded
```

Keep the logs. Together they are your record of what was added and when.

Part 9 - If it stops with an error

1. Read the last ERROR line in the terminal. Note the **row number** (for example #4).
2. Open the screenshot: `start logs\error_row4.png`
3. Check in Advantage whether that component was created or half-created.
4. Fix the cause (see Part 11), or send Claude the error line and the screenshot.
5. Continue from that row: in `add_components.py` set `START_FROM_ROW_ID = 4`, save, and run again.

If the component was created but the grid row was not saved, the next run may skip it (it looks for it in the grid) or fail to create it again. Check it in Advantage and fix that one by hand if needed.

After the run that finishes the rest, set `START_FROM_ROW_ID = 1` again.

Part 10 - Check the result in Advantage

After Round 1 and after every few runs:

1. Log in to Advantage, tenant **royal**.
2. Setup → Academic → Academics → Programs → Cosmetology → **Definition**.
3. **ADD/VIEW COURSE** → open *Written Exams (Quizzes + Exams) - Cosmetology*.
4. Compare with the Excel row:
 - [] Component name is correct
 - [] Number = 0, Weight = 1, Min Score = 75
 - [] Sequence matches column E
 - [] Required / Must Pass checkboxes are correct
 - [] No duplicates

Part 11 - Common problems and fixes

Problem / message	What to do
(.venv) is not showing	Run <code>.venv\Scripts\activate</code>
No module named 'playwright' / 'pandas'	Activate .venv, then <code>pip install playwright pandas openpyxl python-dotenv</code>
SIS_USER / SIS_PASS are missing	.env is missing a line or the name is wrong (Part 2)
Stopped: SIS_URL is the LIVE site	Safety lock. Set <code>ALLOW_LIVE = True</code> only if you are allowed to save on live
403 Forbidden	The site blocks your network. Use VPN, or the site you have access to
Stuck at login or Tenant	Check <code>SIS_TENANT / SIS_TENANT_OPTION</code> in .env. Try <code>SLOW_MO = 500</code>
PermissionError on the Excel	Close the Excel file and run again
KeyError: 'Run' (or another column)	A column in the Excel was renamed. Put the header back exactly
Component not found in the grid list	The component was not saved, or its name is too long / shown differently. Check the screenshot
Timeout ... exceeded	A page was slow or a button changed. Check the screenshot, increase <code>SLOW_MO</code> , run again from that row
Opens the wrong program version	<code>PROGRAM_OPTION</code> needs changing - tell Claude which version you need
Wrong checkbox ticked	Stop and tell Claude which checkbox is Required and which is Must Pass

Part 12 - Open questions before the full run

#	Question	Why it matters
1	Which System component type is used for Practical Exam ?	The 7 practical rows stay Run = No until this is known
2	In the grid, is the 1st checkbox Required and the 2nd Must Pass ?	The script ticks them in that order
3	Is the 25 character limit real?	243 names are longer. Advantage accepted 42 characters in the recording
4	Are you approved to save on the live site for this school?	The dev site gave 403

Part 13 - Quick command card

Start

```
cd C:\Automation\advantage-sis-bot
.venv\Scripts\activate
```

Edit

```
code .env # login details
code add_components.py # LIMIT, DRY_RUN, ALLOW_LIVE, START_FROM_ROW_ID
start data\automation_ready.xlsx
```

Run

```
python add_components.py
```

Stop

Click in the terminal and press **Ctrl + C**.

Logs

```
dir logs
$last = Get-ChildItem logs\components_*.csv |
    Sort-Object LastWriteTime | Select-Object -Last 1
start $last
start logs\error_row5.png
```

Settings for each round

Round	LIMIT	DRY_RUN	ALLOW_LIVE
Test	1	True	False
First save	1	False	True
More	3 / 10 / 50	False	True
All	400	False	True
Finished (lock)	1	True	False